

Ass, The Domestic

This document describes the **domestic ass**, its characteristics, its uses, and the laws and miracles associated with it. The text primarily references the Bible to support its claims.

- The domestic ass was considered **unclean** according to Leviticus.
- It was seen as **strong, intelligent, and fond of ease**, often **fed on vine leaves** and **formed a significant part of patriarchal wealth**.
- The ass was **used in agriculture, for bearing burdens, riding, harness, and war**.
- **Women and people of rank** often rode on asses, and **judges in Israel** rode on white ones.
- **Young asses** were valued for labor, and **trustworthy people were appointed to care for them**.
- The Bible also notes that corrupt rulers often took asses unlawfully.
- **Laws regarding asses** included **prohibitions against coveting, yoking them with oxen, and working them on the Sabbath**.
- The Bible also mentions that people were **obligated to assist a fallen ass** and **return a stray one to its owner**.
- The **firstborn of an ass** had to be redeemed or have its neck broken.
- **Christ's entry into Jerusalem on a donkey** and **miracles involving Balaam's ass and Samson's jawbone** are significant biblical events associated with the animal.
- The ass was **eventually seen as an ignoble creature**.

Overall, the document provides a comprehensive overview of the domestic ass's role and significance in biblical times, highlighting its various uses, legal considerations, and symbolic importance.

Ass, The Domestic

Unclean.

Leviticus 11:2-3 Speak unto the children of Israel, saying, These are the beasts which ye shall eat among all the beasts that are on the earth. 3 Whatsoever parteth the hoof, and is clovenfooted, and cheweth the cud, among the beasts, that shall ye eat.

Leviticus 11:26 The carcasses of every beast which divideth the hoof, and is not clovenfooted, nor cheweth the cud, are unclean unto you: every one that toucheth them shall be unclean.

DESCRIBED AS

Not devoid of instinct.

Isaiah 1:3 The ox knoweth his owner, and the Ass his master's crib: but Israel doth not know, my people doth not consider.

Strong.

Genesis 49:14 Issachar is a strong Ass couching down between two burdens:

Fond of ease.

Genesis 49:14-15 Issachar is a strong Ass couching down between two burdens: 15 And he saw that rest was good, and the land that it was pleasant; and bowed his shoulder to bear, and became a Servant unto tribute.

Often fed on vine-leaves.

Genesis 49:11 Binding his foal unto the vine, and his ass's colt unto the choice vine; he washed his garments in wine, and his clothes in the blood of grapes:

Formed a part of patriarchal wealth.

Genesis 12:16 And he entreated Abram well for her sake: and he had sheep, and oxen, and he asses, and menservants, and maidservants, and she asses, and camels.

Genesis 30:43 And the man increased exceedingly, and had much cattle, and maidservants, and menservants, and camels, and asses.

Job 1:3 His substance also was seven thousand sheep, and three thousand camels, and five hundred yoke of oxen, and five hundred she asses, and a very great household; so that this man was the greatest of all the men of the east.

Job 42:12 So the LORD blessed the latter end of Job more than his beginning: for he had fourteen thousand sheep, and six thousand camels, and a thousand yoke of oxen, and a thousand she asses.

WAS USED

In agriculture.

Isaiah 30:6 The burden of the beasts of the south: into the land of trouble and anguish, from whence come the young and old lion, the viper and fiery flying serpent, they will carry their riches upon the shoulders of young asses, and their treasures upon the Bunches of Camels, to a people that shall not profit them.

Isaiah 30:24 The oxen likewise and the young asses that ear the ground shall eat clean provender, which hath been winnowed with the shovel and with the fan.

For bearing burdens.

Genesis 42:26 And they laded their asses with the Corn, and departed thence.

1 Samuel 25:18 Then Abigail made haste, and took two hundred loaves, and two bottles of wine, and five sheep ready dressed, and five measures of parched Corn, and an hundred clusters of raisins, and two hundred cakes of figs, and laid them on asses.

For riding.

Genesis 22:3 And Abraham rose up early in the morning, and saddled his ass, and took two of his young men with him, and Isaac his son, and clave the wood for the Burnt Offering, and rose up, and went unto the place of which God had told him.

Numbers 22:21 And Balaam rose up in the morning, and saddled his ass, and went with the Princes of Moab.

In harness.

Isaiah 21:7 And he saw a chariot with a couple of horsemen, a chariot of asses, and a chariot of camels; and he hearkened diligently with much heed:

In war.

2 Kings 7:7 Wherefore they arose and fled in the twilight, and left their tents, and their Horses, and their asses, even the camp as it was, and fled for their life.

2 Kings 7:10 So they came and called unto the porter of the city: and they told them, saying, We came to the camp of the Syrians, and, behold, there was no man there, neither voice of man, but Horses tied, and asses tied, and the tents as they were.

Governed by a bridle.

Proverbs 26:3 A whip for the horse, a bridle for the ass, and a rod for the fool's back.

Urged on with a staff.

Numbers 22:23 And the Ass saw the angel of the LORD standing in the way, and his sword drawn in his hand: and the Ass turned aside out of the way, and went into the field: and Balaam smote the ass, to turn her into the way.

Numbers 22:27 And when the Ass saw the angel of the LORD, she fell down under Balaam: and Balaam's Anger was kindled, and he smote the Ass with a staff.

Women often rode on.

Joshua 15:18 And it came to pass, as she came unto him, that she moved him to ask of her Father a field: and she lighted off her ass; and Caleb said unto her, What wouldest thou?

1 Samuel 25:20 And it was so, as she rode on the ass, that she came down by the Covert of the hill, and, behold, David and his men came down against her; and she met them.

Persons of rank rode on.

Judges 10:3-4 And after him arose Jair, a Gileadite, and judged Israel twenty and two years. 4 And he had thirty sons that rode on thirty Ass colts, and they had thirty cities, which are called Havothjair unto this day, which are in the land of Gilead.

2 Samuel 16:2 And the king said unto Ziba, What meanest thou by these? And Ziba said, The asses be for the king's household to ride on; and the bread and summer fruit for the young men to eat; and the wine, that such as be faint in the wilderness may drink.

Judges of Israel rode on white.

Judges 5:10 Speak, ye that ride on white asses, ye that sit in Judgment, and walk by the way.
Young, most valued for labor.

Isaiah 30:6 The burden of the beasts of the south: into the land of trouble and anguish, from whence come the young and old lion, the viper and fiery flying serpent, they will carry their riches upon the shoulders of young asses, and their treasures upon the Bunches of Camels, to a people that shall not profit them.

Isaiah 30:24 The oxen likewise and the young asses that ear the ground shall eat clean provender, which hath been winnowed with the shovel and with the fan.

Trusty persons appointed to take care of.

Genesis 36:24 And these are the children of Zibeon; both Ajah, and Anah: this was that Anah that found the Mules in the wilderness, as he fed the asses of Zibeon his Father.

1 Samuel 9:3 And the asses of Kish Saul's Father were lost. And Kish said to Saul his son, Take now one of the servants with thee, and arise, go seek the asses.

1 Chronicles 27:30 Over the camels also was Obil the Ishmaelite: and over the asses was Jehdeiah the Meronothite:

Often taken unlawfully by corrupt rulers.

Numbers 16:15 And Moses was very wroth, and said unto the LORD, Respect not thou their offering: I have not taken one Ass from them, neither have I hurt one of them.

1 Samuel 8:16 And he will take your menservants, and your maidservants, and your goodliest young men, and your asses, and put them to his work.

1 Samuel 12:3 Behold, here I am: Witness against me before the LORD, and before his anointed: whose ox have I taken? or whose Ass have I taken? or whom have I defrauded? whom have I oppressed? or of whose hand have I received any bribe to blind mine eyes therewith? and I will restore it you.

Latterly counted as an ignoble creature.

Jeremiah 22:19 He shall be buried with the burial of an ass, drawn and cast forth beyond the

gates of Jerusalem.

LAWS RESPECTING;

Not to be coveted.

Exodus 20:17 Thou shalt not Covet thy neighbour's house, thou shalt not Covet thy neighbour's wife, nor his manservant, nor his maidservant, nor his ox, nor his ass, nor any thing that is thy neighbour's.

Fallen under a burden, to be assisted.

Exodus 23:5 If thou see the Ass of him that hateth thee lying under his burden, and wouldest forbear to help him, thou shalt surely help with him.

Astray, to be brought back to its owners.

Exodus 23:4 If thou meet thine enemy's ox or his Ass going astray, thou shalt surely bring it back to him again.

Deuteronomy 22:1 Thou shalt not see thy brother's ox or his sheep go astray, and hide thyself from them: thou shalt in any case bring them again unto thy brother.

Astray, to be taken care of till its owner appeared.

Deuteronomy 22:2-3 And if thy brother be not nigh unto thee, or if thou know him not, then thou shalt bring it unto thine own house, and it shall be with thee until thy brother seek after it, and thou shalt restore it to him again. 3 In like manner shalt thou do with his ass; and so shalt thou do with his raiment; and with all lost thing of thy brother's, which he hath lost, and thou hast found, shalt thou do likewise: thou mayest not hide thyself.

Not to be yoked with an ox.

Deuteronomy 22:10 Thou shalt not plow with an ox and an Ass together.

To enjoy the rest of the Sabbath.

Deuteronomy 5:14 But the Seventh Day is the Sabbath of the LORD thy God: in it thou shalt not do any work, thou, nor thy son, nor thy daughter, nor thy manservant, nor thy maidservant, nor thine ox, nor thine ass, nor any of thy cattle, nor thy stranger that is within thy gates; that

thy manservant and thy maidservant may rest as well as thou.

First-born of, if not redeemed, to have its neck broken.

Exodus 13:13 And every firstling of an Ass thou shalt redeem with a lamb; and if thou wilt not redeem it, then thou shalt break his neck: and all the firstborn of man among thy children shalt thou redeem.

Exodus 34:20 But the firstling of an Ass thou shalt redeem with a lamb: and if thou redeem him not, then shalt thou break his neck. All the firstborn of thy sons thou shalt redeem. And none shall appear before me empty.

Christ entered Jerusalem on.

Zechariah 9:9 Rejoice greatly, O daughter of Zion; shout, O daughter of Jerusalem: behold, thy King cometh unto thee: he is just, and having Salvation; lowly, and riding upon an ass, and upon a colt the foal of an ass.

John 12:14 And Jesus, when he had found a young ass, sat thereon; as it is written,

Miracles CONNECTED WITH;

Mouth of Balaam's opened to speak.

Numbers 22:28 And the LORD opened the mouth of the ass, and she said unto Balaam, What have I done unto thee, that thou hast smitten me these three times?

2 Peter 2:16 But was rebuked for his iniquity: the dumb Ass speaking with man's voice forbade the madness of the prophet.

A thousand men slain by Samson with a jaw-bone of.

Judges 15:19 But God clave an hollow place that was in the jaw, and there came water thereout; and when he had drunk, his spirit came again, and he revived: wherefore he called the name thereof Enhakkore, which is in Lehi unto this day.

Water brought from the jaw-bone of.

Judges 15:19 But God clave an hollow place that was in the jaw, and there came water thereout; and when he had drunk, his spirit came again, and he revived: wherefore he called

the name thereof Enhakkore, which is in Lehi unto this day.

Not torn by a lion.

1 Kings 13:28 And he went and found his carcase cast in the way, and the Ass and the lion standing by the carcase: the lion had not eaten the carcase, nor torn the ass.

Eaten during famine in Samaria.

2 Kings 6:25 And there was a great famine in Samaria: and, behold, they besieged it, until an ass's head was sold for fourscore pieces of silver, and the fourth part of a cab of dove's dung for five pieces of silver.